

howler" and "dangerous alarmist." Mr. Taft characteristically kept his head, and Colonel Townsend was not removed. A good deal of property in the Mississippi Valley was "removed," and it is needless to record that New Orleans did not escape. The railroads and great industrial concerns, where they were likely to be affected, took the warning seriously, with advantage to themselves. The mayor of New Orleans subsequently rescinded the resolution, with an apology. Anyone who knows one of the ablest and least advertised engineers in the United States Army will readily understand that Townsend regarded the mayor and the previous mass meeting with equal indifference.

*A prophet, especially in Wall Street, takes his
life in his hands.*

SYNCHRONIZING THE PRICE MOVEMENT

It has been said before that Dow's theory is in no sense to be regarded as a gambler's system for beating the game. Any trader would disregard it at his peril, but Dow himself never considered it in that light, as I can testify from many discussions with him. I was writing the stock market paragraphs of the Dow-Jones news service and *The Wall Street Journal* in those days, and it was, of course, essential that I should thoroughly understand so scientific a method of synchronizing the market movement. Many men in Wall Street knew Dow and set their experience at his service. His mind was cautious to a fault, but logical and intellectually honest. I did not always agree with him and he was oftener right than I. When he was wrong it was clearly from lack of accurate data such as is now available. . . .